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~~TOP SECRET~~

July 27, 1950

MEMORANDUM FOR THE PRESIDENT

The following notes contain a summary of the discussion at the 62nd meeting of the National Security Council, at which you presided.

1. UNITED STATES OBJECTIVES AND PROGRAMS FOR NATIONAL SECURITY (NSC 68)

THE NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL:

Noted the following statement by the President:

"The steps which we are now taking in the interests of our national security will have far-reaching effect upon the foreign, military, and domestic situation. I am therefore concerned that, despite our preoccupation with the developments in Korea, we also attempt as best we can to project our plans and programs ahead for the next four or five years. Only by such future planning will the steps which we are taking follow an orderly sequence and lead to the eventual achievement of our objectives.

"Future planning of this nature was envisaged by Secretaries Acheson and Johnson in the report which I referred to the Council in April as NSC 68. Recommendations based on that report have, in my opinion, become more rather than less urgent since the Korean development. In view of this situation, as well as the need to be developing our 1952 budget plans beginning in September, I would like the Council to submit to me its response to NSC 68 not later than September 1st."

NOTE: The President's directive establishing the deadline date of September 1 subsequently referred to the Ad Hoc Committee on NSC 68 for appropriate action.

2. COMMUNICATIONS INTELLIGENCE REQUIREMENTS AND MOBILIZATION (Memo for NSC from Executive Secretary, same subject, dated July 20, 1950)

THE NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL:

Approved the recommendations contained in paragraph 3 of the memorandum by the United States Communications Intelligence Board attached to the reference memorandum.

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NOTE: The President participated in the above action. Accordingly, the recommendation in paragraph 3-b of the memorandum by USCIB subsequently transmitted to the member departments and agencies thereof for implementation.

3. U. S. COURSES OF ACTION IN THE EVENT SOVIET FORCES ENTER KOREAN HOSTILITIES
(NSC 76 and 76/1)

SECRETARY JOHNSON expressed concern that we might become over committed in Korea. He felt that the NSRB comments suggested going farther in that direction than Defense intended. He pointed out that Defense had only suggested that we prepare to minimize our commitments, postponing the decision as to the steps to be taken until the event.

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GENERAL BRADLEY explained that precise measures to minimize our commitments in Korea could not be foreseen until the event. He said that the Joint Chiefs felt that we should not fight a major war in Korea. He further explained that the form and timing of the execution of our war plans could only be decided at the time under the circumstances existing.

SECRETARY ACHESON said that he welcomed the assurances that we would only prepare to execute war plans since he felt that we should endeavor to line up our allies on our side prior to the execution.

THE VICE PRESIDENT suggested that it would be appropriate then to decide when the President would go to Congress.

THE PRESIDENT referred to a recent conversation with Mr. Pauley. Mr. Pauley quoted Stalin in a personal interview during the war as saying it was not possible for the Soviets to feed or support a large army east of the Urals unless oil was furnished under lend-lease. The President felt that the oil situation may still exist. That is what makes the President uneasy over the situation in the Persian Gulf area. He felt that this area and the Black Sea straits were places to watch most carefully.

MR. HARRIMAN said that a team sent by the Joint Chiefs of Staff to help Russia plan its participation in war with Japan concluded that even with a build-up the Soviets could only conduct a four months campaign in the Far East. Oil was a critical item in this plan.

THE NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL:

Noted and discussed the reference reports and referred them to the NSC Consultants and Staff for the preparation of recommendations for Council action thereon.

4. THE SITUATION IN THE FAR EAST

THE NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL:

a. Noted an oral briefing on the situation in the Far East by the Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff.

b. Agreed with the recommendation by the Secretary of State that aerial reconnaissance over Korean territory to the limits of the present blockade on the east coast and up to the Yalu River on the west should be authorized, in order to establish the fact of support to the North Koreans by the USSR and the Chinese Communists.

NOTE: The action in b above subsequently transmitted to the Secretary of Defense for appropriate action.

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5. GENERAL POLICY OF THE UNITED STATES CONCERNING FORMOSA
(Memo for the Secretary of Defense from the Joint Chiefs of Staff, same subject, dated July 27, 1950)

SECRETARY JOHNSON read from the reference memorandum the recommendations of the Joint Chiefs regarding Formosa.

SECRETARY ACHESON said that he agreed to the proposal to grant aid. He also agreed that we should send a mission but thought that further work should be done in working over the Joint Chiefs' recommendations. He suggested putting a high ranking officer in Formosa. He also suggested constituting an arrangement to have the command pass to Admiral Struble in the event of an attack. He felt that the Erskine Mission should not go in since they might link this mission's work with French Indo-China, Siam, etc. up with Chiang, which would be politically inadvisable.

SECRETARY JOHNSON said that he would not object to other arrangements regarding the mission but felt that whoever went in should be General MacArthur's man.

MR. SYMINGTON said that he understood from NSC staff discussions that the military felt it might not be possible to prevent the Chinese Communists from taking Formosa. If this is true, he felt that the Formosa situation should be re-examined.

SECRETARY JOHNSON said that is what is coming later.

SECRETARY ACHESON noted the reference to the possibility that the Seventh Fleet might not be in a position to defend Formosa if events in Korea required the Fleet. In that case Secretary Acheson

thought there would be no hope of holding Formosa.

GENERAL BRADLEY explained that since we cannot count on keeping the Seventh Fleet off Formosa that was one reason why we should take steps to strengthen Nationalist forces.

SECRETARY ACHESON agreed that the Nationalist forces should be strengthened, but only to back up the Seventh Fleet.

THE NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL:

a. Discussed the recommendations of the Joint Chiefs of Staff contained in the reference memorandum.

b. Noted the President's approval in principle of these recommendations subject to agreement by the Secretaries of State and Defense as to the specific content and wording thereof.

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NOTE: The decision in b above subsequently referred to the Secretaries of State and Defense for appropriate action.

6. RECONSTITUTION OF THE NSC STAFF
(NSC Action No. 302-a)

THE NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL:

In the light of the President's letter to Council members dated July 19, 1950, regarding the Council and its Staff, discharged the special NSC committee on the above subject which was created by NSC Action No. 302-a.

7. STATUS OF NSC PROJECTS

THE NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL:

Noted the Status of NSC Projects as of July 24, 1950.